ATLAS TECHNOLOGY DIVISION | FP&A DASHBOARD | OCT-26 CLOSE & Q4 OUTLOOK

Fictional company • synthetic data • illustrative salaries • not affiliated with Equifax

REPORTING STATE ▼	MONTH ▼	DEPARTMENT ▼	SCENARIO ▼	FIGURE TYPE
B – After investigation (10 Nov)	Oct-26	All	Base	ACTUAL (incl. estimated accrual)

As at 10-Nov-26 • Scope: salary + contractor (on-costs excluded) • Variance = Actual − Budget (+ = adverse) • Forecast = Base scenario (illustrative)

GROSS EXPENDITURE	BUDGET	VARIANCE	Q4 FORECAST	OPERATING EXPENSE
£50,083	£57,950	(£7,867)	£162,917	£42,166
Payroll + accrual (posted)	*Driver-based*	*Favourable – mainly timing*	*Vs budget -£10,033*	*P&L after capitalisation*

APPROVED CAPITALISATION	TIMECARD COMPLETENESS	UNRESOLVED EXCEPTIONS	MONTH-END CLOSE	VARIANCE %
£7,917	90.3%	2	10 of 10	(13.6%)
Posted £7,917	*Expected hours recorded (Oct)*	*Controls Red/Amber; open items 1*	*Released with disclosed exceptions*	*Variance ÷ budget*

BEFORE → AFTER CONTROL RESOLUTION (October)

Measure	Before	After	Change
Completeness %	86.8%	**90.3%**	3.5%
Unallocated payroll (£)	£6,395	**£5,218**	(£1,177)
Approved capitalisation (£)	£7,887	**£7,917**	£30
Posted capitalisation (£)	-	**£7,917**	£7,917
Posted P&L labour expense (£)	£42,583	**£42,166**	(£417)
Control exceptions (Red+Amber)	6	**2**	(4)
Missing employee-days	3	**0**	(3)
Material project variances open	8	**0**	(8)
Close steps complete (of 10)	3	**10**	7

OPEN MANAGEMENT ACTIONS (after investigation)

Not adjusted retrospectively: reliable supporting evidence for the missing partial-day hours was unavailable. Full-day timecard booking required from November; unallocated cost stays in non-project expense. – Financial Controller

October cost expensed: technical feasibility could not be demonstrated when the cost was incurred, so under IAS 38 it cannot later be added to the asset. Capitalise future cost only once the 16-Nov review confirms all criteria. – Technical Accounting / Financial Controller

No cause asserted. Largest residual £870 (Technology RSH-301). Engineering Lead coding referred to the DEV-101 project manager for confirmation – Project manager / Finance analyst

Confirm the Senior Data Engineer start date; keep the vacancy underspend in the Q4 forecast – D&A lead

Reverse the October accrual on 1 Nov and match it to the contractor invoice – Finance analyst

MANAGEMENT INSIGHTS (formula-driven)

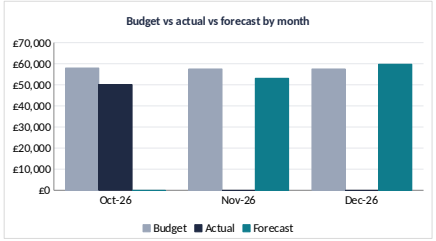
1. October expenditure was £50,083 against a £57,950 budget (£7,867 favourable, 13.6%). The gap is mainly timing – the unfilled Senior Data Engineer post (-£6,500) and the contractor's late start (-£3,150) – partly offset by higher salaries (+£1,033) and the contractor day rate (+£750). The underspend should not be released.

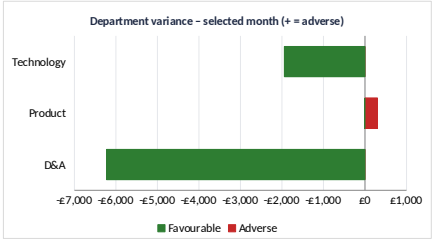
2. Expenditure includes a £7,500 contractor accrual (an estimate for services received but not yet invoiced). Posted P&L labour cost was £42,583 before investigation (payroll only) and £42,166 after the accrual and capitalisation journals were approved and posted.

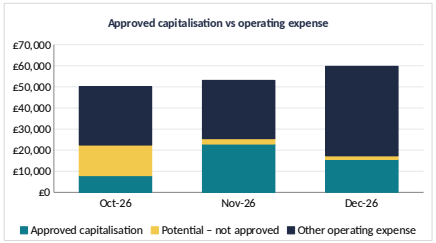
3. Timecard completeness improved from 86.8% to 90.3% (target 98%); unallocated payroll fell from £6,395 to £5,218. Remaining partial-day gaps were not adjusted because reliable supporting evidence was unavailable in the simulation: total cost is unaffected, but capitalisation may be understated.

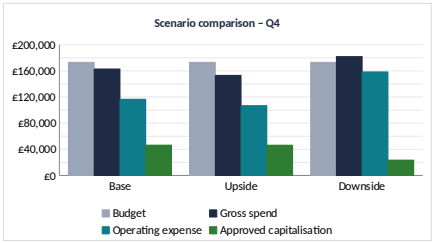
4. £7,917 of £22,412 potentially eligible development labour was approved and posted as capitalised. DEV-202's £13,615 stays expensed because technical feasibility could not be demonstrated when the cost was incurred (review due 16 Nov); under IAS 38 it cannot later be added to the asset.

5. Month-end close: 3 of 10 steps complete before investigation, 10 of 10 after – released with disclosed exceptions. Remaining risks: partial timecards, possible under-capitalisation and an unexplained £870 coding difference (Technology RSH-301) referred to the project manager.









Before investigation = original month-end position (6 Nov 2026); After investigation = corrected position (10 Nov 2026), simulated. Actual = October payroll and approved timesheets; Estimated = contractor accrual; Forecast = Nov–Dec scenario values (illustrative). Fictional company, synthetic data, developed with AI assistance, not yet tested in Microsoft Excel.

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A – Before investigation (6 Nov)	Oct-26	All	Base	ACTUAL (incl. estimated accrual)

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Payroll + accrual (prepared)	*Driver-based*	*Favourable – mainly timing*	*Vs budget -£10,033*	*P&L after capitalisation*

APPROVED CAPITALISATION	TIMECARD COMPLETENESS	UNRESOLVED EXCEPTIONS	MONTH-END CLOSE	VARIANCE %
£7,887	86.8%	6	3 of 10	(13.6%)
Posted £0	*Expected hours recorded (Oct)*	*Controls Red/Amber; open items 12*	*Blocked*	*Variance ÷ budget*

BEFORE → AFTER CONTROL RESOLUTION (October)

Measure	Before	After	Change
Completeness %	86.8%	**90.3%**	3.5%
Unallocated payroll (£)	£6,395	**£5,218**	(£1,177)
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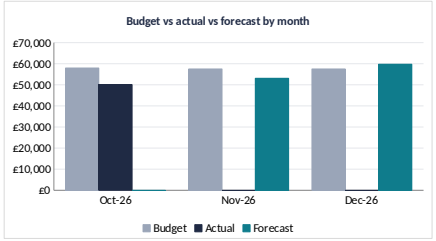
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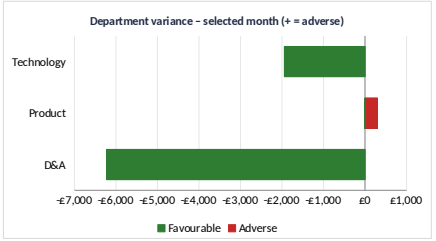
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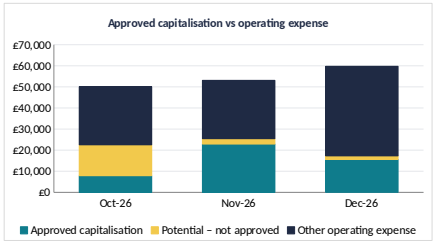
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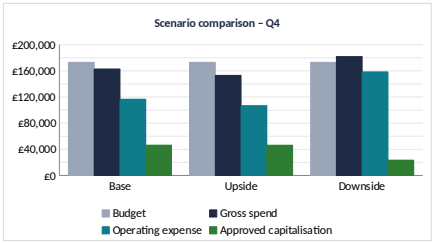
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